

Word family: **light / lights / lit / lighted / lighting / lighter / lightest / lightly / lighten / lightened / lightening / lightness**

Base word: light

Verb forms: light / lights / lit / lighted / lighting

Comparative / superlative adjective: lighter / lightest

Related forms:

light (n.) — 光；燈；光線

light (adj.) — 明亮的；淺色的；輕的；少量的

light (v.) — 點燃；照亮

lightly (adv.) — 輕輕地；輕微地；不嚴肅地

lighten (v.) — 使變亮；使變淡；使減輕

lightness (n.) — 明亮；淺色；輕盈；輕微

lighting (n.) — 照明；燈光配置

Useful extensions:

light up

light up a room

in the light

in light of

bring something to light

come to light

shed light on

see something in a new/different light

green light

red light

traffic light

daylight

sunlight

moonlight

highlight

light-hearted

lightweight

Meaning in this passage

> He **lights up the room** without trying too hard, and his enthusiasm is genuinely contagious.

Here, **light up the room** is **figurative**.

It means:

to make a place feel happier, warmer, livelier, or more positive because of your presence — 令整個地方氣氛變得更開朗、更有活力

Leo does not literally switch on a lamp. His personality and enthusiasm make the atmosphere around him brighter and more cheerful.

中文翻譯：

他不用刻意做甚麼，就能**令整個房間的氣氛都活躍 / 明亮起來**，而且他的熱情真的很有感染力。

A natural learner-friendly rendering is:

light up the room = 使全場氣氛變得開朗、有活力；令身邊的人感到愉快

1. **light (光) — 光；光線**

This is the central noun meaning.

Practice 1

> Bright **light** came through the window.

明亮的**光線**從窗戶照進來。

Practice 2

> Plants need **light** to grow.

植物需要**光**才能生長。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 使人能夠看見物體的自然或人造光線

2. **a light (燈；光源) — 一盞燈；一個光源**

Unlike the uncountable noun **light**, countable **a light** often means a lamp or source of illumination.

Practice 1

> I left a **light** on in the kitchen.

我在廚房留了一盞**燈**亮着。

Practice 2

> There was a small **light** beside the bed.

床邊有一盞小**燈**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a light = 產生光線的燈或其他光源

3. **turn on/off the light — 開燈 / 關燈**

Practice 1

> Could you **turn on the light**?

你可以**開燈**嗎？

Practice 2

> Don't forget to **turn off the lights** before you leave.

離開前別忘了**關燈**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the light(s) = 房間或地方內用來照明的燈

4. **light (交通燈 / 訊號燈) — 燈號**

Practice 1

> The **light** turned green.

交通燈轉成綠色。

Practice 2

> Stop when the **light** is red.

****紅燈**時要停車。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****light = 用顏色或亮起狀態傳達訊號的燈****

5. ****traffic light — 交通燈****

Practice 1

> Turn left at the next ****traffic light****.

在下一個****交通燈****左轉。

Practice 2

> We waited for the ****traffic lights**** to change.

我們等候****交通燈****轉燈。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****traffic light = 用紅、黃、綠燈控制道路交通的訊號裝置****

6. ****light (火焰 / 點火用的火) — 火 ; 火種****

In some contexts, ****a light**** means something used to light a cigarette, candle, etc.

Practice 1

> Have you got a ****light****?

你有****火 / 打火機****嗎？

Practice 2

> He asked someone for a ****light****.

他向別人借****火****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a light = 用來點燃香煙等物品的火或點火工具****

7. **light a candle/fire/cigarette (點燃) — 點着 ; 點燃**

As a verb, **light** can mean cause something to begin burning.

Practice 1

> She **lit** a candle.

她**點燃**了一支蠟燭。

Practice 2

> They **lit** a fire to keep warm.

他們**生火**取暖。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 使某物開始燃燒

8. **light something / be lit by (照亮) — 照亮**

Practice 1

> Candles **lit** the room.

蠟燭**照亮**了房間。

Practice 2

> The street was **lit by** old-fashioned lamps.

街道由老式路燈**照亮**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 向某個地方提供光線 , 使其變亮

9. **light up (亮起) — 亮起來 ; 發光**

Literal phrasal extension.

Practice 1

> The screen **lit up** when I touched it.

我碰到螢幕時，它便**亮了起來**。

Practice 2

> The whole building **lit up** after dark.

天黑後，整座建築物都**亮了起來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light up = 開始發光或變得明亮

10. **light something up (照亮某地) — 把.....照亮**

Practice 1

> Fireworks **lit up the sky**.

煙花**照亮了天空**。

Practice 2

> Hundreds of lanterns **lit up the street**.

數百盞燈籠**照亮了街道**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light something up = 使某個地方因光線而變得明亮

11. **someone's face/eyes light up — 臉 / 眼睛突然流露喜悅**

A very common figurative extension.

Practice 1

> Her face **lit up** when she saw her grandson.

她看見孫兒時，臉上立即**露出喜悅的神情**。

Practice 2

> His eyes **lit up** when I mentioned the trip.

我提到旅行時，他的眼睛立即**亮了起來 / 流露出興奮**。

MCQ-ready definition:

someone's face/eyes light up = 某人突然顯得非常高興、興奮或有興趣

12. **light up the room (figurative)** — 令全場氣氛變得明亮、愉快、有活力

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He **lights up the room** without trying too hard.

他不用刻意，就能**令整個房間的氣氛變得開朗而有活力**。

Practice 2

> Her warm personality **lights up every room she enters**.

她溫暖的個性令她走進的每個地方都**充滿愉快活力**。

Practice 3

> The little girl's laughter **lit up the room**.

那個小女孩的笑聲令整個房間的氣氛都**明朗起來**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light up the room = 因自己的個性、笑容或活力而使周圍氣氛變得更愉快、更溫暖、更有生氣

13. **light (明亮的)** — 光線充足的；明亮的

Adjective.

Practice 1

> The kitchen is very **light** and airy.

廚房很**明亮**，而且空氣流通。

Practice 2

> I prefer a **light** room with large windows.

我較喜歡有大窗戶、光線**明亮**的房間。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 有充足光線、不昏暗的

14. **light colour** (淺色的) — 淺色的

Practice 1

> She painted the walls a **light blue**.

她把牆壁漆成**淺藍色**。

Practice 2

> **Light colours** make the room look larger.

淺色會令房間看起來更大。

MCQ-ready definition:

light + colour = 顏色較淡、接近白色的

15. **light** (重量輕的) — 輕的 ; 不重的

This is a major independent adjective sense.

Practice 1

> This suitcase is surprisingly **light**.

這個行李箱出奇地**輕**。

Practice 2

> The box is **light enough** for me to carry.

這個箱子**夠輕**，我搬得動。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****light = 重量不大、不重的****

16. ****light clothing/material — 輕薄的****

Practice 1

> Wear ****light clothing**** in hot weather.

炎熱天氣應穿****輕薄的衣服****。

Practice 2

> The jacket is made from a ****light material****.

這件外套由****輕薄物料****製成。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****light = 重量輕、質地不厚重的****

17. ****light meal / light food — 清淡的；份量較少的****

Practice 1

> I only want a ****light meal**** tonight.

我今晚只想吃一頓****清淡 / 份量較少的餐點****。

Practice 2

> We had a ****light lunch**** before the meeting.

開會前我們吃了一頓****簡單清淡的午餐****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****light food/meal = 份量不多、較容易消化或味道不濃重的食物 / 一餐****

18. ****light drink / light beer — 酒精含量較低或味道較淡的****

Practice 1

> He prefers **light beer**.

他較喜歡**味道較淡 / 酒精含量較低的啤酒**。

Practice 2

> This wine is pleasantly **light**.

這款酒味道舒服而**清淡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 味道、濃度或酒精強度較低的

19. **light rain/snow** — 小雨；小雪；程度輕微的

Practice 1

> There will be **light rain** this afternoon.

今天下午會有**小雨**。

Practice 2

> We had **light snow** overnight.

昨晚下了**小雪**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 強度較低、程度輕微的

20. **light traffic** — 車流量少的

Practice 1

> Traffic is usually **light** early in the morning.

清晨的車流通常比較**少**。

Practice 2

> We arrived quickly because the traffic was **light**.

因為交通**不繁忙 / 車流量少**，我們很快便到了。

MCQ-ready definition:

light traffic = 道路上的車輛不多

21. **light workload / duties** — 工作量少的；負擔較輕的

Practice 1

> My workload is fairly **light** this week.

我這星期的工作量比較**少 / 輕**。

Practice 2

> He returned to **light duties** after his injury.

受傷後，他先恢復做一些**較輕鬆的工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 工作、責任或負擔的程度不重

22. **light exercise** — 輕量運動

Practice 1

> The doctor recommended **light exercise**.

醫生建議做**輕量運動**。

Practice 2

> Start with some **light stretching**.

先做一些**輕度伸展**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 所需體力較少、強度不高的

23. **light touch — 輕輕的觸碰**

Practice 1

> She felt a **light touch** on her shoulder.

她感到肩膀被**輕輕碰了一下**。

Practice 2

> Use a **light touch** when applying the paint.

塗顏料時要用**輕柔的力度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 力度小、不重的

24. **light sleep / light sleeper — 淺眠；容易醒的人**

Practice 1

> I'm a very **light sleeper**.

我是個很容易醒的**淺眠者**。

Practice 2

> She was in a **light sleep** when the phone rang.

電話響起時，她正處於**淺睡狀態**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light sleep = 不深的睡眠，容易被聲音或動靜弄醒

25. **light reading / entertainment — 輕鬆的；不費腦筋的**

Practice 1

> I wanted some **light reading** for the journey.

我想找一些適合旅途中看的**輕鬆讀物**。

Practice 2

> The programme provides **light entertainment**.

這個節目提供**輕鬆娛樂**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light = 不沉重、不複雜、不需要太多思考的

26. **light-hearted** — 輕鬆愉快的；不嚴肅的

Practice 1

> The film is mostly **light-hearted**.

這部電影整體上相當**輕鬆愉快**。

Practice 2

> They had a **light-hearted conversation** over dinner.

他們吃晚飯時進行了一場**輕鬆愉快的談話**。

MCQ-ready definition:

light-hearted = 心情輕鬆愉快、沒有沉重或嚴肅氣氛的

27. **make light of something** — 輕視；淡化某事的嚴重性

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Don't **make light of** the problem.

不要**輕視 / 淡化**這個問題。

Practice 2

> He tried to **make light of** his injury.

他試圖把自己的傷勢**說得沒甚麼大不了**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****make light of something = 把嚴重或重要的事情說得不重要、不值得擔心****

28. ****take something lightly — 不把某事太當回事；輕率看待****

Practice 1

> You shouldn't ****take this decision lightly****.

你不應該****輕率看待****這個決定。

Practice 2

> Safety is not something we ****take lightly****.

安全不是我們可以****掉以輕心****的事情。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****take something lightly = 沒有以足夠認真或慎重的態度看待某事****

29. ****lightly (輕輕地) — 輕柔地；力度小地****

Practice 1

> She ****lightly touched**** his arm.

她****輕輕碰了碰****他的手臂。

Practice 2

> Dust the cake ****lightly**** with sugar.

在蛋糕上****輕輕撒上****糖粉。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****lightly = 以很小的力度、重量或程度****

30. ****lightly dressed / lightly covered — 穿得單薄；覆蓋得很少****

Practice 1

> He was too **lightly dressed** for the cold weather.

這麼冷的天氣，他**穿得太單薄**。

Practice 2

> The ground was **lightly covered** with snow.

地面**薄薄地覆蓋着**一層雪。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

lightly = 以較少、較薄或程度不深的方式

31. **lighten (使變亮) — 使更明亮**

Practice 1

> White walls can **lighten** a dark room.

白色牆壁可以令昏暗的房間**變得更明亮**。

Practice 2

> The sky began to **lighten** before sunrise.

日出前天空開始**變亮**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

lighten = 使某物變得更明亮，或開始變亮

32. **lighten a colour / hair — 使顏色變淺**

Practice 1

> The sun **lightened** her hair.

陽光令她的頭髮顏色**變淺**。

Practice 2

> Add some white paint to **lighten the colour**.

加一點白色顏料，把顏色**調淺**。

MCQ-ready definition:

lighten = 使顏色變得較淡或較接近白色

33. **lighten a load / burden — 減輕重量或負擔**

Practice 1

> Let me carry one of those bags to **lighten your load**.

讓我幫你拿一個袋，**減輕你的負擔**。

Practice 2

> Extra staff helped **lighten her workload**.

額外人手幫助**減輕了她的工作量**。

MCQ-ready definition:

lighten = 使重量、工作量或負擔減少

34. **lighten the mood / atmosphere — 緩和氣氛；令氣氛輕鬆**

Practice 1

> He told a joke to **lighten the mood**.

他說了個笑話來**緩和氣氛 / 令氣氛輕鬆一點**。

Practice 2

> Her smile **lightened the atmosphere**.

她的笑容令氣氛**輕鬆了不少**。

MCQ-ready definition:

lighten the mood/atmosphere = 使原本沉重、緊張的氣氛變得較輕鬆

35. **lighten up** — 放輕鬆；別那麼嚴肅

Informal.

Practice 1

> **Lighten up**! It was only a joke.

放輕鬆一點吧！那只是一個玩笑。

Practice 2

> He needs to **lighten up** and stop worrying about every small mistake.

他需要**放鬆一點**，不要每個小錯誤都那麼擔心。

MCQ-ready definition:

lighten up = 變得較放鬆、較不嚴肅或較少擔心

36. **in the light** — 在光線下

Literal.

Practice 1

> The colour looks different **in natural light**.

這個顏色在**自然光下**看起來不一樣。

Practice 2

> Hold the photograph up to the **light**.

把照片拿到**光線下**看看。

MCQ-ready definition:

in the light = 在有光線照射的情況下

37. **in light of something** — 鑑於；考慮到

A major figurative expression.

Practice 1

> **In light of** the new evidence, the decision was reviewed.

鑑於有了新證據，該決定被重新檢討。

Practice 2

> We changed our plans **in light of** the weather forecast.

考慮到天氣預報，我們改變了計劃。

MCQ-ready definition:

in light of something = 考慮到某項新資訊、情況或事實

38. **shed light on something — 闡明；幫助理解**

Practice 1

> The report **sheds light on** the causes of the problem.

這份報告**有助說明 / 闡明**問題的成因。

Practice 2

> Her explanation **shed new light on** the situation.

她的解釋令大家對情況有了**新的理解**。

MCQ-ready definition:

shed light on something = 提供資料或解釋，使某事變得較容易理解

39. **bring something to light — 揭露；使真相曝光**

Practice 1

> The investigation **brought several problems to light**.

調查**揭露了**幾個問題。

Practice 2

> New documents **brought the truth to light**.

新文件令真相**曝光**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bring something to light = 把原本隱藏或不知道的事情揭露出來

40. **come to light** — 被發現；曝光

Practice 1

> New evidence has **come to light**.

新的證據已經**曝光 / 被發現**。

Practice 2

> Several mistakes **came to light** during the review.

檢討期間有幾個錯誤**被發現了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

come to light = 原本不為人知的事情被發現或公開

41. **see something in a different/new light** — 以不同 / 新的角度看某事

Practice 1

> The conversation made me **see the problem in a different light**.

那次談話令我**以不同角度看待這個問題**。

Practice 2

> After hearing her explanation, I saw him **in a new light**.

聽過她的解釋後，我**重新看待他**。

MCQ-ready definition:

see something/someone in a new light = 因得到新資訊而改變看法或理解方式

42. **paint/present someone in a good/bad light — 把某人描寫得好 / 差**

Practice 1

> The article presents the company **in a positive light**.

那篇文章把公司**描寫得很正面**。

Practice 2

> The report showed the manager **in a bad light**.

那份報告令經理**顯得形象很差**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****show/present someone in a particular light = 以某種方式塑造別人對某人的看法****

43. **green light (批准 ; 許可) — 綠燈 ; 正式批准**

Figurative from traffic signals.

Practice 1

> The project has been given the **green light**.

這個項目已經獲得**正式批准**。

Practice 2

> Management finally **gave us the green light** to begin.

管理層終於**批准我們開始**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****give something the green light = 正式批准某件事開始進行****

44. **red light (停止 / 警告訊號) — 紅燈 ; 停止或警告訊號**

Practice 1

> A **red light** indicates that you must stop.

紅燈表示你必須停下。

Practice 2

> The warning should have been a **red light** for investors.

那項警告本來應該是給投資者的一個**危險警號**。

MCQ-ready definition:

red light = 字面上是停止的紅燈；引申為危險、停止或警告的訊號

Important distinction 1: **light (noun)** vs a **light**

light — usually uncountable

= 光

> We need more **light**.

我們需要更多**光線**。

a light — countable

= 一盞燈 / 一個光源

> There is **a light** by the door.

門旁有**一盞燈**。

Important distinction 2: **light** vs **lamp**

light

Can refer to:

- * the illumination itself
- * a source of illumination
- * a room light

lamp

Specifically the physical device.

> Turn on the **light**.

開燈。

> I bought a new desk **lamp**.

我買了一盞新檯燈。

Important distinction 3: **light** vs **bright**

light

can mean having plenty of light:

> a **light** room

> 一個光線充足的房間

bright

emphasizes strong illumination:

> a **bright** room

> 一個很明亮的房間

They overlap, but **bright** more strongly emphasizes intensity.

Important distinction 4: **light** vs **pale**

For colours:

light blue

= 淺藍色

pale blue

= 淡藍色；顏色較蒼白、柔淡

Pale often suggests less saturation, whereas **light** mainly contrasts with **dark**.

Important distinction 5: **light** vs **lightweight**

light

ordinary adjective meaning not heavy:

> a **light** bag

一個很輕的袋

lightweight

often means specifically designed or made to weigh little:

> a **lightweight** laptop

一部**輕量化**手提電腦

It can also figuratively mean someone/something lacking seriousness or importance in certain contexts.

Important distinction 6: **light** vs **slight**

These can both correspond to 「輕微」 in Chinese, but they are not interchangeable everywhere.

light rain

小雨

slight pain

輕微痛楚

Light is strongly conventional with weather, food, work, exercise, touch, etc.

Slight often means small in degree or amount.

Important distinction 7: **light up** vs **brighten**

light up

Can be literal or figurative:

> The room **lit up**.

房間亮了起來。

> Her face **lit up**.

她臉上露出喜悅。

brighten

means become brighter or more cheerful:

> The room **brightened**.

房間變亮了。

> Her mood **brightened**.

她的心情變好了。

Important distinction 8: **light up the room — literal vs figurative**

Literal

> The lamps **lit up the room**.

燈光**照亮了房間**。

Figurative

> Leo **lights up the room**.

Leo **令整個房間的氣氛都變得更愉快、更有活力**。

Your passage is clearly **figurative**.

Important distinction 9: **lighten vs light**

light

can itself be a verb:

> **light** a candle

> 點燃蠟燭

> **light** the room

> 照亮房間

lighten

means **become/make lighter**:

> **lighten** the room

> 令房間變得更明亮

> **lighten** the workload

> 減輕工作量

So they are related but not interchangeable.

Important distinction 10: **light** vs **lightning**

These are different words.

light

光；燈；輕的；淺色的

lightning

閃電

> a flash of **lightning**

一道閃電

This distinction is especially useful because your previous sentence contained **lightning speed**.

Important distinction 11: **lightening** vs **lightning**

Also easy to confuse:

lightening

from **lighten**

= 變亮、變淡、減輕

> The sky is **lightening**.

天空正在變亮。

lightning

= 閃電

> We saw **lightning**.

我們看見閃電。

Important distinction 12: **make light of vs take lightly**

make light of something

= deliberately treat something as less serious

> He **made light of** the danger.

他把危險說得沒甚麼大不了。

take something lightly

= fail to treat it seriously enough

> Don't **take the warning lightly**.

不要對這個警告掉以輕心。

The first emphasizes **how you present the matter**; the second emphasizes **your attitude toward it**.

Family-extension note

Light is one of the strongest polysemy words in this passage because several major semantic

branches have become established in modern English:

1. ****illumination****

- * light, sunlight, a light, lighting

2. ****providing illumination / ignition****

- * light a candle
- * light a room
- * light up

3. ****brightness / pale colour****

- * light room
- * light blue

4. ****low weight****

- * light bag
- * light material

5. ****low intensity / amount****

- * light rain
- * light traffic
- * light exercise
- * light meal

6. ****figurative cheerfulness or positivity****

- * face lights up
- * light up the room
- * lighten the mood

7. ****knowledge and understanding****

- * shed light on
- * come to light
- * see in a new light

These are not merely different Chinese translations caused by context; several are genuinely distinct lexical branches. At the same time, phrases such as ****light rain****, ****light traffic****, and ****light exercise**** share the broader idea of ****low intensity/quantity****, so they should be grouped rather than artificially treated as unrelated meanings.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
light (noun)	光；光線	illumination
a light	燈；光源	source of light
traffic light	交通燈	signal
a light for a cigarette	火；火種	ignition
light a candle	點燃蠟燭	make burn
light a room	照亮房間	illuminate
light up	亮起	become illuminated
light up the sky	照亮天空	illuminate something
face/eyes light up	臉 / 眼睛流露喜悅	suddenly become delighted
light up the room	令全場氣氛愉快、有活力	figurative positivity
light room	明亮的房間	plenty of light
light blue	淺藍色	pale colour
light bag	輕的袋	low weight
light clothing	輕薄衣物	low weight/thickness
light meal	清淡 / 份量少的一餐	low heaviness/amount
light beer	較淡 / 較低酒精啤酒	low strength
light rain	小雨	low intensity
light traffic	車流量少	low quantity
light workload	工作量較少	low burden
light exercise	輕量運動	low intensity
light touch	輕觸	low force
light sleep	淺睡	not deep
light reading	輕鬆讀物	not serious/demanding
light-hearted	輕鬆愉快的	cheerful/not serious
make light of	輕視；淡化	treat as less serious
take lightly	輕率看待	not treat seriously
lightly	輕輕地；輕微地	low force/degree
lighten a room	使房間變亮	make brighter
lighten a colour	使顏色變淺	make paler
lighten a burden	減輕負擔	reduce weight/burden
lighten the mood	緩和氣氛	make less serious
lighten up	放輕鬆	become less serious
in light of	鑑於；考慮到	considering evidence
shed light on	闡明	increase understanding
bring to light	揭露	reveal
come to light	被發現；曝光	become known
see in a new light	以新角度看	change perspective
in a positive light	以正面形象呈現	presentation/perception
green light	批准	permission
red light	警號；停止訊號	warning/stop

For your original sentence

> He **lights up the room** without trying too hard, and his enthusiasm is genuinely contagious.

Here:

light up the room = 令整個地方的氣氛變得更愉快、更溫暖、更有生氣

The phrase is metaphorical:

physical light makes a room brighter

→ **a cheerful, energetic person makes the emotional atmosphere feel brighter**

So Leo's presence has a positive effect on everyone around him.

A very natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他不用刻意做甚麼，就能**令整個房間的氣氛都活躍起來**。

or slightly more expressive:

> 他不用刻意做甚麼，就能**令整個地方都充滿歡樂和活力**。

That figurative **light up** sense is the key one for this passage.